

Particulars	Gold Jewellery	Gold Coins	Digital Gold	Gold ETF	Sovereign Gold Bonds
Costs	Need to pay additional making charges (12%-30%) and 3% GST. Bank Locker charges if stored there.	Making charges range from 5-10% and 3% GST is charged.	3% GST Charged	Expense ratio of around 1%.	Demat account opening and transaction costs like Brokerage Charges on transactions if any.
Storage	Need to store safely or a bank locker.	Need to store safely or a bank locker.	No storage required.	No storage required.	No storage required.
Taxation	If held for less than 3 years: taxable as per income tax slab rates. If held for more than 3 years: gains taxed at 20% w/indexation.	If held for less than 3 years: taxable as per income tax slab rates. If held more than 3 years: gains taxed at 20% w/indexation.	If held for less than 3 years: taxable as per income tax slab rates. If held more than 3 years: gains taxed at 20% w/indexation.	If bought on or after 1 April, 2023 it will be taxed according to your tax slab. And for physical gold and digital gold (need to add +4% cess) 20% +4% cess w/indexation	Interest is taxable as per your tax slab. Capital gains are exempted from tax if held till maturity.
Liquidity	Can buy/sell at jewellers or use it as a collateral.	Can be bought at jewellers or banks. Although banks won't buy the gold coins back from you.	Buy online, redeem as coins/bullion, or cash out.	Exchange-traded, bought/sold only during market hours.	Exchange-traded, bought/sold only during market hours.
Pros	Higher aesthetic value.	Higher resale value due to purity.	Ease of buying.	Ease of buying and no GST is charged along with high liquidity.	No GST charged, Tax benefits with added 2.5% interest.
Cons	Up to 25% lost as making charges and storage costs.	Making charges and storage costs.	GST charged; not in other electronic gold buying methods.	No added interest.	Withdrawal before 5 years is difficult as it is not very liquid.